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CHATHAM, N.J.
EPEE ONLY, AS ALWAYS

The EN GARDE GAZETTE
THE ELITE FENCERS CLUB WEEKLY

MONDAY EDITION
OCTOBER 13, 2026
PRICE: ONE TOUCH

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Team USA Sweeps Pan-Am Epee Gold in Lima

Comebacks in both team finals cap a six-gold weekend for the Americans in Lima.

GAZETTE STAFF · EPEE ONLY, AS ALWAYS

The United States won all six team gold medals at the Pan American Senior Zonal Championships in Lima, Peru, with both epee squads delivering the weekend's best drama. The men trailed Venezuela 33–31 after seven legs before Gabriel Feinberg posted a 9–2 eighth leg, and anchor Ariel Simmons held off a 16–5 closing run from Colombia's John Edison Rodriguez to win 45–42.

The women were even more commanding, beating Canada 41–31 behind Hadley Husisian, Catherine Nixon, Charlene Kai Yan Liu, and Tierna Oxenreider. In individual action, Anna van Brummen upset Husisian 15–13 for women's epee gold in a 68-fencer field.

Why it matters here: zonals use the same relay format as our regional events — closing tight legs without panicking is exactly what coaches preach in our room. Feinberg's patience and Simmons holding a shrinking lead are the two hardest things in team fencing.

RATINGS EARNED

NAME	RATING	EVENT
Maya R.	B26	Cadet WE
Daniel K.	D26	Y14 ME
Sofia L.	E26	Y12 WE
James T.	A26	Div IA ME

SCOREBOARD

SRC	RESULT
FIE	Song reclaims world epee crown in priority-minute final
FIE	Budapest GP: Lehis, Santuccio set up epee showdown
USA	Junior men's epee takes first-ever world team title
NJ HS	Preseason polls: Chatham 3rd in epee
SYC	Four Elite FC fencers reach DEs in Edison

NAC Season Opens in Orlando This Week

The October NAC runs Oct. 9–12 in Orlando with Division I, cadet, Y14, cadet team, and parafencing — the first national points of the season. The Division I epee fields show who spent the summer training. Admission is free; results post same-day. Next: Columbus in November, Milwaukee in December.

Chatham Ranked 3rd in Preseason Epee Poll

Preseason polls place Chatham third in boys' epee and fifth in girls', with several Elite FC fencers expected to anchor both squads. Dual meets begin in December. High-school fencing is where many of our fencers first fence for something bigger than themselves.

Winter Camp Returns Dec 27–31

Our ninth annual high-performance epee camp runs the last week of the year, 9:30am–2pm daily: footwork, technical and tactical drills, conditioning, video review, and a Friday team tournament. Open to all levels at $395 for the week or $95 a day, with a sibling discount.

SIGNUP BOARD — WHO'S IN (COMPACT)

TOURNAMENT	EVENTS (EPEE)	CLOSES	ELITE FC ENTERED
Hub City Fall Epee Open, New Brunswick	Y14 / Cadet / Senior Mixed	Oct 16	Maya R., Daniel K., Sofia L. +4
Garden State RJC, Edison	Cadet / Junior	Oct 21	James T., Priya S. +2
November NAC, Columbus OH	Div I / Junior / Cadet	Oct 28	Travel group forming — ask at desk

New Passivity Rule Starts Oct 1: Red, Then Black

Under the new rule, stalling no longer earns a warning. The first passivity call goes straight to a **red card** — a touch for the opponent — and the second to a **black card**: exclusion from the bout. Yellow cards for passivity are gone entirely. The intent is to keep bouts fencing instead of circling. For our fencers the lesson is simple: always show the referee clear attacking intent, especially late in a period, because the call will now come faster and cost more. Expect referees to enforce it strictly through the fall while everyone adjusts.

Ice Cream Makes Fencers Ten Times Better

A groundbreaking Gazette investigation of the club freezer confirms it: fencers who eat ice cream between periods win ten times as many bouts. Chocolate beats vanilla 15–14 in overtime. Side effects include sticky gloves and questionable footwork. More research — and sprinkles — needed.

WHERE TO WATCH — EPEE ON SCREEN

EVENT	WHEN	WATCH
October NAC, Orlando — Div I epee finals	Oct 11–12	USA Fencing YouTube (free)
Casablanca Epee World Cup	Oct 15–18	FencingTV.com (sub.)
Veteran Worlds, Tbilisi	Oct 9–17	FencingTV.com (sub.)
First to 15 podcast	Anytime	Podcast apps (free)
November NAC, Columbus — Div I epee	Nov 20–23	USA Fencing YouTube (free)
Youth Olympics, Dakar — epee	Fall 2026	Olympic Channel (free)

Watch like a fencer: pick one fencer and count their advances before each touch. You'll start seeing the setup two moves before the light goes on — that's distance, and it's the whole weapon.

DEADLINES

DATE	DEADLINE
Oct 16	Hub City Open entries close
Oct 21	Garden State RJC prereg closes
Oct 28	November NAC regular-fee deadline
Nov 1	USFA membership renewals due

NEXT GAZETTE — THURSDAY

Full signup board, late-entry locals, and weekend logistics. On the club desk Thursday morning.

CLUB THIS WEEK

DAY	WHAT'S ON
Mon–Fri	3–9pm classes + open fencing
Saturday	8:30am–3pm; 10am Y10/Y12 practice tournament
Sunday	Closed
Dec 27–31	Winter Camp — sign up at desk

NEW FACES

Saturday tryouts brought four new beginners into the club, ages eight to twelve, all starting in epee. They spent the morning learning the guard position, the advance, and the most important lesson of all: how to salute. Returning members are asked to say hello on the strip — everyone remembers their first night holding a weapon that felt impossibly long. Parents: the beginner parent briefing runs the first Tuesday of each month at 6pm.

FENCING 101 — THE DOUBLE TOUCH

Epee has no right-of-way: if both fencers hit within about 40 milliseconds, **both score**. That's why you see 1–1 counters where foil would give one light. Lesson for beginners: when you're up by one late in a bout, don't chase — make them come to you, because a double keeps your lead. When you're down, avoid the double at all costs; only single-light touches change the math. Tied at the end of a direct-elimination bout, epee goes to a one-minute priority round after a draw for who advances on a tie — win the draw and the pressure flips entirely: your opponent must score, and you only need one light. Body contact is its own lesson: corps-à-corps to avoid a touch is penalized, so keep your distance honest even when the strip gets crowded.

CLUB RESULTS

EVENT	BEST ELITE FC FINISH
Garden State RJC	Maya R. 6th, Cadet WE
Garden State RJC	Daniel K. T8, Y14 ME
Hub City Open	Sofia L. 3rd, Y12 WE
Edison SYC	Two medals, Y14

MILESTONES

50th Gazette touch: this issue marks our second prototype — thank you to everyone who squinted at v1. **Welcome** to our four newest beginners from Saturday tryouts. **Good luck** to the Orlando travel group at the October NAC. **100-DE club:** congratulations to Daniel K., who fenced his 100th recorded direct-elimination bout this month — the first hundred are the hardest. **Blade milestone:** Sofia L. broke her first blade in competition and kept fencing. That's not a loss, that's an initiation. **Strip record:** Saturday's practice tournament drew twenty-two fencers, our biggest in-club turnout this season.

[COMIC]

Frank's panel goes here.
Bot reserves this space.

ABOUT THIS PAPER

Edited by Frank, printed at the club. Tips, links, and comics go by email to the paper's inbox. No bylines for the editor; guests get credited. Past issues live in the binder at the club desk — ask for the Gazette archive.